



INSTITUTIONAL COURSE SYLLABUS

Course Code: COM 201	Course Title: Introduction to Communication Skills
Course Instructor: Ms Hannah Sarpong	Email: hsarpong@psu.edu.sa
Credit Hours: 3	Course Location: s.1380 W175 Aud/ W175 Aud/W252 (8-9am MON - AUD, 9-10am – MON - AUD 8-9am WED W252)
Scheduled Office Hours: 12-2pm (M/W/Th)	
Office Location: W256	
Co-Requisite: N/A	Prerequisite: N/A
On Campus	

Mission Statement

The Department of General Studies aims to provide quality education in the fields of Islamic Education, Arabic Literature, World Languages, Social Sciences, and Health and Physical Education. The department strives to empower and prepare students to participate in the real world by integrating physical, mental, and spiritual values. The department also seeks to develop essential skills including creative and critical thinking, oral and written communication in different areas of knowledge.

- I. Course Description:** The course is designated to familiarize students with the processes of Communication in interpersonal, organizational, mass and intercultural contexts. Topics covered include: Communication paradigms, perceptual processes, personal and professional relationships. The course also includes materials related to verbal and non-verbal Communication, Communications technology, and the role Communication plays in culture.
- II. Course Learning Outcomes:** On the successful completion of this course, students will be able to demonstrate the following:

Skills	Course Learning Outcomes
Knowledge & Understanding	1.1 Recognize the fundamental components, concepts, and terminologies of human communication Measured through assignments, major and final exams
Skills	2.1 Analyze and explain academic, personal and professional communication situations through verbal and non-verbal languages, and communication technologies

	2.2. Utilize critical thinking, listening and information literacy skills to solve communication problems Measured through assignments, demonstrations, major and final exams, and discussions
Values	3.1 Demonstrate knowledge of components and ethical behavior in various contexts of communication 3.2 Demonstrate communication competence through understanding the perceptual process, presentation, conflict management, and leadership skills Measured through assignments, major and final exams, demonstrations, or other projects.

III. Tentative Weekly Course Schedule: *May change to accommodate guest presenters & student needs.*

WEEK	UNIT/ TOPIC	CLO(s) alignment	STUDENT TASKS	Number of Contact hours
Wk 1	Syllabus review & acknowledgment, class rules, teacher introduction. Introduction to acquiring course resources. Introduction of assessment plan, explanation of final project. Chapter 1: Introduction to Human Communication Pg. 2-12		Read the syllabus and fill out the syllabus acknowledgment form. Acquire textbook. Read assigned sections of the textbook.	3
Wk 2	Confirmation of Syllabus acknowledgment. (LMS) Chapter 1: Introduction to Human Communication Pg. 12-26 Chapter 2: Perception, Self and Communication	1, 3	Read Chapter from textbook, discussions	3
Wk 3	Chapter 2: Perception, Self and Communication & Chapter 3: Language and Meaning	1, 3	Read Chapter from textbook, discussions	3
Wk 4	Chapter 3: Language and Meaning	1, 2	Read Chapter from textbook, discussions	3
Wk 5	Chapter 4: Nonverbal Communication	1, 2	Read Chapter from textbook, discussions Quiz 1 – Chap 1-3	2
Wk 6	Chapter 4: Nonverbal Communication	1, 2, 3	Read Chapter from textbook, discussions	3

	----- Chapter 5: Listening and Critical Thinking			
Wk 7	Chapter 5: Listening and Critical Thinking ----- Preparation and setting up groups for the final project. ----- Review for Major Exam	1, 2, 3	Feb 13 (Thu): Major Exam – Chap 1-5	3
Wk 8	Chapter 6: Interpersonal Relationships Feb. 23 (Sun): Holiday	1, 2, 3	Read Chapter from textbook, discussions	2
Wk 9	Chapter 6: Interpersonal Relationships ----- Chapter 7: Inclusive Communication	1, 2, 3	Read Chapter from textbook, discussions	3
	<i>Feb. 28-Apr. 5: Ramadan/Eid break</i>			
Wk 10	Chapter 8: Small Group Communication 20% grades to students & department	1, 2, 3	Read Chapter from textbook, discussions	2
Wk 11	Chapter 8: Small Group Communication	1, 2, 3	Read Chapter from textbook, discussions	3
Wk 12	<u>Chapter 9: Workplace Communication</u> Final project preparation: group work, planning, arranging tutorials.	1, 2, 3	Quiz 2 – Chapters 6-8	3
Wk 13	<u>Chapter 9: Workplace Communication</u> Final project preparation: group work, planning, arranging tutorials.	All CLOs	Group meetings, finalize planning projects	3
Wk 14	Project presentations – all class periods used. May 4-5: Holiday: Long weekend	All CLOs	Presenting projects for a grade.	3
Wk 15	Project presentations Exam Revision & make-up work 60% grades to students	All CLOs	Read Chapter from textbook, discussions	3

IV. Student Assessment & Teaching Strategies:



Domain	Assessment Task	Teaching Strategy
Knowledge	Assignments, quizzes and exams	Interactive lectures, shared videos and materials, and discussions
Skills	Assignments, demonstrations, and exams	Interactive lectures, practical applications, and discussions
Values	Assignments, demonstrations, and exams	Assignments, practical application in discussions, and demonstrations

- V. **Course Requirements** All course requirements should be completed based on the instructions announced during class or posted on Moodle. Including quizzes, assignments, presentations, and exams. Students should ask questions for clarification if needed.

Quizzes: Two quizzes to assess your understanding and comprehension of communication.

Major exam: The major exam will assess your understanding of communication in a conceptual and applicable means. It consists of MCQ, True/False, matching, and application /short answers questions.

Final presentations: Students will present about a topic related to communication. Follow instructions and rubrics posted on Moodle.

NOTE: Any **PLAGIARIZED** parts will result in rejecting the assignment, and the student will get a zero for that assignment. This includes using AI.

VI. Schedule of Assessment

Assessment	Assessment Task	Week Due	% of Final Assessment
1	Major	Week 7	20
2	2 Main Quizzes	Week 5 & 12	10 (5% each)
3	Assignments	Ongoing	20
4	Reflection/Group presentations	Week 13-15	10
5	Final Exam (Ch.1-9)	Exam period	40
	Total		100%

VII. Learning Resources

A. References - required text, essential references, recommended books, electronic materials, websites, and other learning materials. Please indicate proper bibliographic entry).

i. Required Text -- Available online:

Pearson, J. C., Nelson, P.E., Titsworth, S., Hosek, A. M. (2024) Human Communication. (8th Edition - Summer 2024) New York, NY: McGraw Hill.

ii. Supplemental text:

Trenholm, S. (2014) Thinking through Communication (7th Edition). Essex, England: Pearson Education Limited. Shared materials and videos.

B. Facilities Required – Lecture Room with computer, internet, projector and screen.

C. Digital Tools – This course will utilize a variety of digital tools such as the Coursera Platform, MOODLE (LMS), and other types of digital tools (Kahoot, Edpuzzle, etc.).

D. Learning Management System – LMS using “Moodle” is required; items such as syllabus, course materials, assignments, rubrics, and announcements will be delivered through Moodle.

E. Online Courses: Google Meet –If for any reason during the semester, the class will need to meet as a group/class online, then a link will be shared prior to the session.

F. Writing and Tutoring Center – Students are highly advised to use the Writing and Tutoring Center’s academic services by booking tutoring/writing appointments through the **booking system:** (<https://psu.mywconline.net/>)

VIII. Classroom Policies

A. Student Grades Policy

It is the student's sole responsibility to keep up with his/her performance throughout the semester. Although students deal with a variety of personal issues that may affect his/her performance, the ultimately responsibility falls on the student. Instructors will **NOT** deal with communications/correspondence that asks a student to be lenient, and let the student pass a course (even though he/she has not performed to the appropriate level), or grant a student a higher grade even though it wasn't earned (a.k.a "help").

Understand that:

- Instructors are not responsible for a student's scholarship. That is a student responsibility.
- Instructors are not responsible for a student's grade point average (GPA). This includes meeting requirements to stay enrolled at the university. That is a student responsibility.
- Instructors are not responsible for external issues affecting performance. That is a student responsibility.
- Instructors will not take into consideration that a student is repeating a course. Repeating a course is a student issue and his/her responsibility to manage.
- Instructors are not responsible for student's mismanagement of time. This includes managing other courses in addition to this one. That is a student responsibility.
- Instructors are not responsible for a student's graduation requirement. That is a student responsibility.
- Not all issues mentioned are the only student issues. These are the most common ones.
- Any other student issue not mentioned is also a student responsibility.

B. Academic Integrity Policy (e.g., plagiarism or dishonesty)

"Plagiarism can be defined as unintentionally or deliberately using another person's writing or ideas as though they are one's own. Plagiarism includes, but is not limited to, copying another individual's work and taking credit for it, paraphrasing information from a source without proper documentation, and mixing one's own words with those of another author without attribution. In addition, buying a paper or project, or downloading a paper from the Internet, or utilizing AI software, and submitting them as your own is also plagiarism. The penalty for academic dishonesty will bring course expulsion and failure, or even suspension" (Academic Integrity and Syllabus Acknowledgement Form).

All students are expected to submit their 'own' work and not the work of others.

C. Attendance Policy

Please, adhere to the following guidelines:

1. The University attendance policy will be strictly followed. In this course, the absence of **12 or more** course hours results in a Denied Notice (DN). (Refer to the student regulation handbook for further details.)

Please Note: IT IS THE SOLE RESPONSIBILITY OF THE STUDENT TO KEEP SATISFYING their level of attendance. Otherwise, a "DN" grade will be granted automatically during any time in the semester without any notice from the e-register system.



2. The student is marked absent if they are not in the classroom **10 minutes after the start of class time**. The student will be marked absent if they leave the classroom for more than 10 minutes in the middle of class time.
 - Students are prohibited of discussing attendance (lates or absences) in class in the presence of other students.
 - The lecturer reserves the right to NOT engage in discussions about absences in the presence of other students nor during office hours.
 - The lecturer will only allow concerns about attendance via email so there is a record of the issue that has arisen.
3. If a student is marked absent for any reason, the class teacher **may not** and **will not** remove the absence. Absences can only be removed by the Department of Student Affairs. Kindly email: dsa@psu.edu.sa with a valid excuse according to the University policy.
4. No make-up exams will be allowed except for university accepted documents. (Refer to the student regulation handbook for further details.)

D. Homework Submission Policy

All assignments must be submitted on time (as per the instructions of your instructor).

- Late submission will **ALWAYS** result in a '0' marks.
- There are no extensions to the deadlines on the McGraw Hill Website
- Students are responsible for their own work and time management.
- If a student is absent throughout an assessment, the student should be highlighted on Edugate as having a "excused absence" by the Department of Student Affairs. Once this is confirmed on the Edugate system, it is still at the discretion of the lecturer whether to allow for the student to submit the assessment at a later date.

IX. Syllabus Amendment

This document is not a fixed document. Scheduled events in the syllabus (e.g. assessments) may need to be rescheduled, adjusted, or canceled for various reasons, including, but not limited to: to accommodate the university administrative matters, events beyond the instructor's control, or governmental mandates.

In the event that the syllabus contains a typographical error, mistake in fact, or a provision that creates an absurd result, then that particular provision is not enforced as stated by the syllabus. Instead, the provision will be enforced consistent with university policies.